LinkedOut

Product Requirements Document

Draft v0.1 • Working tagline: **Know before you join.**

Product vision

LinkedOut is an anonymous workplace intelligence platform that helps people understand what it is really like to work at a company before making a career decision.

Prepared as the initial product blueprint for the LinkedOut MVP.

1. Product Overview

1.1 What is LinkedOut?
LinkedOut is an anonymous workplace intelligence platform where current and former employees can share workplace experiences, while job seekers can research companies before accepting employment.

The platform is designed to answer a simple question: **“What is it actually like to work here?”**

1.2 Product Philosophy
LinkedOut should not become a platform primarily for attacking employers. It should promote honest experiences, constructive feedback, useful workplace information, responsible anonymity, fair representation, and informed career decisions.

2. Problem Statement

Job seekers often have limited information about what happens inside a company. A company’s website, LinkedIn page, job description, or recruitment advertisement may not accurately communicate the day-to-day employee experience.

Potential employees therefore make important career decisions with incomplete information.

At the same time, current and former employees may have valuable experiences they cannot comfortably share publicly under their real names.

LinkedOut’s solution: Create a platform where people can **Research** → **Compare** → **Understand** → **Decide** before joining a company.

3. Target Users

- **Job seekers:** People considering applying to or accepting an offer from a company.
- **Current employees:** Employees who want to anonymously share workplace experiences.
- **Former employees:** People who have left a company and want to document their experience.
- **Employers / company representatives:** Future users who may claim company profiles and respond to employee feedback.
- **Researchers / career professionals:** People interested in aggregated workplace trends and insights.

4. MVP Goals

- **Discovery:** Users can easily find a company.
- **Intelligence:** Users can understand what it is like to work there.
- **Contribution:** Employees can contribute useful anonymous information.

5. MVP Features

5.1. Authentication

V1 supports email/password authentication, email verification, and password reset.

Core principle: Account identity is separate from public identity. A user may have an internal account while their public review appears as “Anonymous Employee” or “Anonymous Former Employee.”

5.2. Company Directory

Users can search and browse companies. Each company should have a name, logo, industry, location, description, website, overall rating, and review count.

Example: **ABC Technologies — 3.7 / 5 — Lagos, Nigeria — Technology — 126 reviews.**

5.3. Company Profile

The company profile is the central product experience.

Sections: company overview; overall rating; workplace ratings; reasons employees leave; employee reviews; and, in a future release, verified company responses.

Workplace rating categories: Compensation, Management, Work-life balance, Career growth, and Workplace culture.

5.4. Employee Reviews

Users can submit workplace reviews.

Required: Company, employment status, job category/role, overall rating, and review text.

Optional: Location, length of employment, pros, cons, whether the user would recommend the company, and reason for leaving.

5.5. Why I Left

“Why I Left” is a signature LinkedOut feature. Users select a primary reason for leaving.

Possible categories: Compensation; Management; Work-life balance; Workplace culture; Career growth; Working conditions; Better opportunity; Relocation; Education; Personal reasons; Other.

Reasons are aggregated on company profiles. Percentages should only be shown when there is enough data to avoid giving misleading impressions from tiny samples.

5.6. Ratings

Overall experience is required. Optional category ratings include Compensation, Management, Work-life balance, Career growth, and Workplace culture.

The overall company rating should be calculated from eligible reviews rather than manually assigned.

5.7. Comments & Reactions

Users can interact with reviews. V1 should use a simple “Helpful” reaction rather than many social-media-style reactions. Users can also comment on reviews, subject to the same moderation rules.

5.8. Reporting

Every review and comment should provide a Report action.

Report reasons: Harassment; Spam; Personal information; False/misleading information; Hate/abusive content; Off-topic; Other.

5.9. Moderation

Moderation is a core requirement. Submitted reviews should initially enter a moderation state.

Suggested lifecycle:

```
PENDING → APPROVED → PUBLISHED
PENDING → REJECTED
PUBLISHED → FLAGGED → REVIEWED
```

5.10. Privacy & Anonymity

The platform must not publicly expose a reviewer's name, email, account identifier, or authentication information.

The database may maintain an internal relationship between a user and their contributions for moderation, abuse prevention, duplicate detection, and account management. This relationship must not be exposed through public APIs.

The product should avoid collecting unnecessary personally identifiable information.

5.11. Abuse Prevention

V1 should include rate limiting, authentication before posting, review moderation, report functionality, duplicate-review detection, spam protection, basic profanity/abuse detection, admin suspension, and audit logs.

Reviews must not be used to publish another person's private information.

5.12. Admin Dashboard

Dashboard: Total users, companies, reviews, pending reviews, reports, and active users.

Review moderation: View pending reviews; approve; reject; flag; remove published reviews.

User management: View accounts, suspend accounts, restore accounts, and review user activity.

Company management: Create companies, edit information, merge duplicates, hide companies, and manage categories.

5.13. Search & Discovery

V1 search should support company-name search. Industry, location, and category filters can be introduced as the directory grows.

The initial search experience should remain simple rather than introducing an unnecessarily sophisticated search engine.

5.14. Saved Companies

Authenticated users can save companies to a personal shortlist for later research.

6. Core User Flows

Job seeker

```
Homepage → Search company → Company profile → Read reviews → View ratings → View "Why people leave" → Make an informed decision
```

Employee

```
Create account → Search/select company → Write review → Select ratings → Select reason for leaving → Submit anonymously → Moderation → Published
```

7. Suggested V1 Pages / Routes

```
/
/companies
/companies/[slug]
/search
/explore
/reviews/write
/login
/register
/dashboard
/dashboard/reviews
/dashboard/saved
/dashboard/settings
/admin
/admin/dashboard
/admin/companies
/admin/reviews
/admin/reports
/admin/users
```

8. Initial Data Model

- User
- Company
- Review
- ReviewRating
- Comment
- Reaction
- Report
- SavedCompany
- Employment
- ModerationAction
- Potential future models: Industry, Location, CompanyClaim, Notification.

9. Technology Direction

The planned implementation should use a modern web stack suitable for rapid development and maintainability.

Frontend: Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS.

Backend: Next.js API / Node.js.

Database: PostgreSQL + Prisma.

Authentication: Keep the initial authentication architecture simple; introduce external providers only where they provide clear value.

Storage: Cloudflare R2 if V1 later requires image/file storage.

Deployment: To be finalized during implementation.

10. Scope Exclusions — V1

- Job marketplace
- Direct messaging
- Native mobile application
- AI career advisor
- Salary negotiation tools
- Advanced employer analytics
- Paid company advertising
- Complex social networking
- Company subscriptions
- Multiple social login providers

11. V1 Success Criteria

The MVP is successful if users can reliably:

Find a company → understand its workplace reputation → read real experiences → contribute their own experience anonymously.

The product should validate whether people will search for companies and contribute useful workplace experiences before major expansion.

12. Initial Market Strategy

The initial market should be Nigeria, with Lagos likely to be the first major source of companies and reviews.

However, the database should support **Country → State/Region → City** from day one so the product is not technically locked to Lagos or Nigeria.

13. Future Direction

Potential future features include verified company profiles, company responses, salary insights, interview-experience reviews, job listings, workplace comparisons, aggregated workplace intelligence, and other career tools.

These should only be prioritized after the core review and discovery loop is validated.

14. Product Principle for AI-Assisted Development

This PRD is intended to serve as the product source of truth for implementation, including AI-assisted/vibe coding workflows.

Implementation should follow the requirements, preserve the core anonymity model, avoid unnecessary architectural complexity, and keep V1 within scope.

Where an implementation decision materially changes product behavior, security, privacy, or architecture, it should be surfaced for review rather than silently invented.